

Signal Radar

Finds family-owned businesses where the founder is still running things and a son or daughter is stepping up beside them — and shows you the company's own words as proof. This is how to use it.

1 Signing in

Web address

`signal-based.vercel.app`

Bookmark this one. Works on a laptop or a phone, nothing to install.

Your account

`jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com`

A second account, `thegoldhillgroup@gmail.com`, also works.

If you ever see "You Need Access", you are on the wrong link. Long addresses containing a jumble of letters — `signal-based-hky0ay13w-...` — are internal previews of individual updates, and they are locked on purpose. The address above is the real one and never asks for approval.

Forgotten the password? Use the "Forgot password?" link on the sign-in page. Passwords are deliberately not written down anywhere, including in this document.

2 The five screens

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR
Overview	Your numbers at a glance, and anything finished while you were away.
Signal Radar	Where you start a new search. This is the main screen.
Enrichment	Finding email addresses for leads you already have.
All Leads	Every lead ever found, across all searches.
Settings	Your ideal client, the vendor keys, and what everything costs.

3 Running a search

Signal Radar → the form is already filled in with sensible defaults, so you can often just press Search.

- 1 **Mode.** Leave it on *Hybrid*. That looks for founder-and-successor pairs and keeps every other good family business it passes on the way.
- 2 **Verticals.** Eight are available — landscaping, home building, construction, specialty trades, manufacturing, distribution, property services, professional services. Pick any combination, or none to search all eight.
- 3 **States.** Your twelve are pre-selected: California, Florida, Texas, New York and the Northeast.
- 4 **Revenue band.** Defaults to \$5–15M, the sweet spot. \$5–30M widens it to your full profile.
- 5 **How many to find.** Higher numbers read more companies and take longer. The form tells you how many it will read and roughly what it will cost.
- 6 **Signal focus (optional).** Tick any of the twelve signals from your profile, or type your own words. This changes what the search looks for.
- 7 **Press Search.** It shows exactly what it will read and what it will cost, and waits for you to confirm.

A big search runs in several passes. The server stops any single run after five minutes. Everything found is saved and the next pass starts on its own — you do not have to do anything.

Searching the same thing twice is not wasted. Every company already looked at is remembered and skipped, so a repeat search goes deeper into the same ground rather than handing back the same list.

4 Reading the results

Each search creates a folder. Inside, leads are split three ways.

Founder + successor

Both generations named, both running it today.
This is what the product is for — and the rarest,
about one company in thirty.

Good fit, no successor yet

Right trade, right area, family-run — but nobody
named to take over. Still worth a call.

Not a fit

Cut, with the reason on the row. Shown so you can disagree with it.

The quote is the point

Every confirmed pair carries a sentence from the company's own website, with a link to the page it came from. You can check any claim in one click. If a lead has no quote, it has not earned the label — and the system lowers it rather than pretending.

Confidence

LABEL	MEANS
High	Both named with titles, explicit succession language, and two or more supporting signals. Act on it.
Medium	The pair is there, but the handover is implied rather than spelled out.
Verify	Real but thin. Worth a look before you call.

5 Finding email addresses

Separate from searching, and never automatic — it costs money per address found.

- 1 Press **Find emails** — on the Overview, inside a folder, or on the Enrichment screen. All three do the same thing.
- 2 Tick who you want: **founder + successor**, **good fits**, or **cut but arguable**. Pairs and fits are ticked for you.
- 3 The button shows the number of companies and the most it can cost. Press it to start.

You are only charged when an address is actually found. A miss costs nothing, so the real figure is almost always lower than the estimate. Every address found is then checked to make sure it is deliverable.

It looks for the successor first. Where a next-generation family member is named, that is who it tries to reach — the founder is the fallback.

6 Getting the list out

- **Download CSV** — opens in Excel or Numbers.
- **Copy for Google Sheets** — copies to your clipboard; paste straight into a sheet.

The file contains exactly what the screen shows. Companies hidden as a different kind of business entirely — funeral homes, newspapers, trade associations — are left out of both.

7 Settings

Your ideal client

The revenue band and the signal focus used by every new search. Change it here and every future search follows — no developer needed.

Vendor keys

Six keys, each with its balance shown live beside it. If a service ever runs out, this is where you paste a new key, and it takes effect immediately.

Monthly harvest

An optional job that searches on its own once a month. **Currently off, and worth leaving off** until you are using the product regularly — it costs money and produces folders whether or not anyone opens them.

8 What it costs

SERVICE	WHAT IT DOES	COST	ACCOUNT
Apify	Finds companies and fetches their pages	\$29 per month	jonathan@
OpenRouter	Reads each page and judges it	~\$0.02 a company	jonathan@
AnymailFinder	Finds an email address	\$0.05 only when found	jonathan@
MillionVerifier	Checks it is deliverable	\$0.006 per check	jonathan@
Firecrawl	Reads pages that need a browser	free	jonathan@
Tavily	Finds trade directories	free	jonathan@

SERVICE	WHAT IT DOES	COST	ACCOUNT
Supabase	The database and the login	free	thegoldhillgroup@
Vercel	Hosts the app	free	thegoldhillgroup@
GitHub	Holds the code	free	thegoldhillgroup@

\$29 a month is the only fixed cost. Everything else moves only when you run a search or look up an email. A typical search is about 45¢.

Two accounts, split by who pays. Everything that costs money sits under jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com. The three free services that host the app — Supabase, Vercel and GitHub — sit under thegoldhillgroup@gmail.com.

9 If something looks wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
"Not enough credit"	A vendor needs topping up. Settings shows which one.
"Stopped at the time limit"	Normal. Everything found is saved — press Search again to carry on.
A search finds very little	Usually that ground is well covered already. Try another state, or widen the verticals.
No founder + successor pairs	Expected on a small search. They occur about once in thirty companies read.
A lead looks wrong	Open it and read the quote. If the quote does not support it, tell Daniel — that is a real fault.

Prepared for The Goldhill Group · 14 August 2026 · Balances and costs shown live in Settings.